

Asia Semiconductors and Equipment & Global Memory

United Microelectronics Corp

Rating

Underperform

Price Target

2303.TT

88.00 TWD

UMC

13.60 USD



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UMC: 3Q26 sales tracking below consensus

UMC reported monthly sales last Friday afternoon. Revenue in August increased by 31% YoY and 5% MoM. July + August sales together amounted to ~NT\$48.9B. That was 65.8% of the company's guidance midpoint, & was at the low-end of the historical range (66-71%). Should September follow seasonality, UMC 3Q26 revenue in NT\$ would be c. 3% below guidance midpoint and 5% below consensus. As FX likely presented a small tailwind in the past 2 months, the possible miss can't be explained by FX (Exhibit 1).

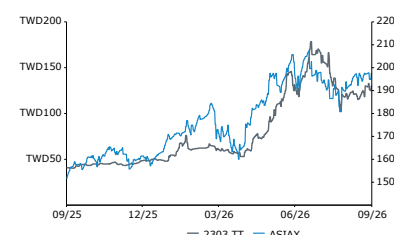
UMC's 3Q26 guidance came in above market expectations likely on higher loading and more resilient end demand. Wafer shipment was guided to be up by HSD% QoQ, driven by strong demand for PMIC, sensors, micro-controllers. That said, ASP was only guided to remain "firm", with a more meaningful uplift expected to take place in 2027. The company also updated its strategy with a target to grow AI-related revenue from US\$300M this year to US\$1B within 3 years. To support this, The company raised its 2026 capex budget from US \$1.5B to US\$2.0B and plans to invest roughly US\$5B through 2027/28 to expand advanced packaging capacity in Singapore and Taiwan, covering technologies such as interposer, DTC, silicon photonics, and hybrid bonding. While geopolitical factors should limit competition from Chinese players, we believe the relatively low barriers to entry in advanced packaging will inevitably attract competition from foundries, OSATs, and, in some segments, memory suppliers, leaving long-term returns uncertain.

On August 26, the board approved the issuance of up to US\$1.8B in convertible bonds, with proceeds primarily earmarked for equipment purchases and fab construction related to these expansion plans. That said, we do not expect meaningful revenue contribution from advanced packaging until late 2027/28, while rising depreciation is likely to weigh on profitability in the interim. With the stock currently trading at 3.7x trailing P/B, we believe the market is pricing in growth benefits that remain several years away. Maintain Underperform.

Close Date	4 Sep 2026
2303.TT Close Price (TWD)	130.00
Price Target (TWD)	88.00
Upside/(Downside)	(32)%
52-Week Range	185.50/40.90
ASIAx	1,948.83
FYE	Dec
Div Yield	2.0%
Market Cap (TWD) (B)	1,634.11
EV (TWD) (B)	1,550.18
Performance	YTD 1M 6M 12M
Absolute (%)	164.0 6.6 109.3 215.5
ASIAx (%)	19.2 2.6 15.2 30.6
Relative (%)	144.8 3.9 94.1 184.9

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Price Performance, 1YR



Reported EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E	Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR	Valuation Metrics	25A	26E	27E
2303.TT (TWD)	3.34	4.58	5.56	Revenues (M)	237,553	274,814	315,887	--	P/B (x)	4.3	3.9	3.6
UMC (USD)	0.54	0.74	0.89	CapEx (M)	47,745	47,176	40,950	--	Reported P/E (x)	38.9	28.4	23.4
				Gross Margin (%)	29.0	31.5	33.2	--	Div Yield (%)	2.2	1.9	2.3
				Operating Margin (%)	18.5	21.1	23.1	--	Adjusted P/E (x)	38.9	28.4	23.4
				Net Income Margin (%)	17.5	20.8	22.0	--	PEG Adjusted (x)	(3.2)	0.8	1.1
				ROE (%)	11.0	14.4	16.1	--	EV/FCF (x)	29.7	18.3	17.1
				Net Debt/Equity (x)	(0.08)	(0.18)	(0.28)	--	EV/EBITDA (x)	15.0	12.4	11.0

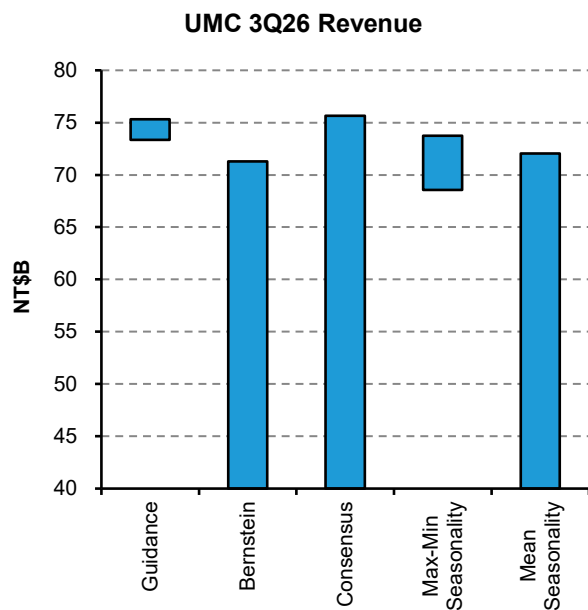
Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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EXHIBIT 1: UMC July + August sales amounted to ~NT \$48.9B. Should September follow seasonality, UMC 3Q26 revenue would be c. 5% below consensus.



We haven't updated the model post 2Q26 earnings.

Source: Company data, Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis

INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

UMC: We rate UMC **Underperform** with TP=**NT\$88.00**.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

4 Sep 2026						TTM	Reported EPS				P/B (x)		
			Closing	Price	Rel.								
Ticker	Rating	Cur	Price	Target	Perf.		Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
2303.TT (UMC)	U	TWD	130.00	88.00	184.9%		TWD	3.34	4.58	5.56	4.3	3.9	3.6
UMC (UMC)	U	USD	20.77	13.60	181.7%		USD	0.54	0.74	0.89	4.5	3.9	3.6
ASIA			1,948.83										
SPX			7,747.71										

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY**United Microelectronics Corp**

We set a NT\$88 1-year target price using a P/B multiple of 2.5x against our forward Q5-Q8 BVPS estimate of NT\$35.2. We derive our PT for secondary ticker (UMC.US) by dividing the primary PT by FX and arrive at US\$13.6.

RISKS**United Microelectronics Corp**

There are a number of upside risks to our UMC target price: (1) Better-than-expected progress/pricing in 28nm; (2) Better-than-expected end demand recovery; (3) Lighter-than-expected competitive pressure from Chinese rivals.

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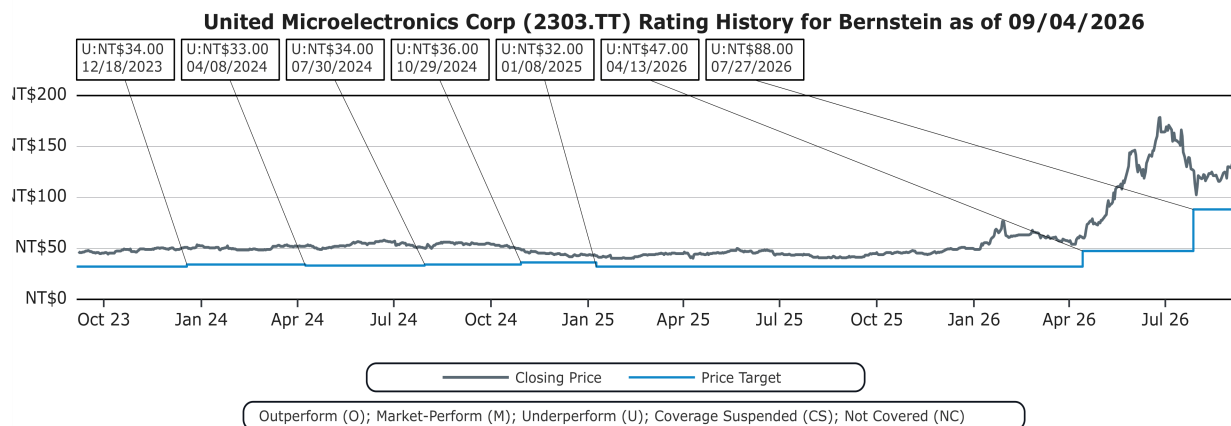
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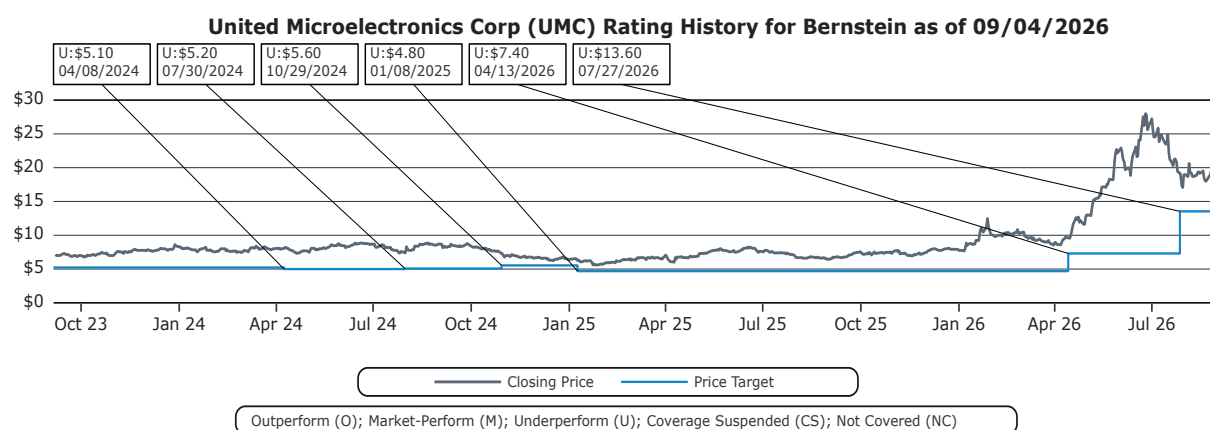
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Underperform	SELL	13.1%	13.6%

* These figures represent the percentage of companies within each equity rating category for which affiliates of Bernstein have provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.
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